

RAMACHANDRAN BALASUBRAHMANIAN

Data & AI Governance Leader · Data Governance · Data Quality · DataOps · Metadata · MDM · DAMA CDMP Master
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95% INCIDENT REDUCTION · 232M+ RECORDS PROTECTED · \$2M+ ANNUAL SAVINGS · RESOLUTION 20-100 HRS → UNDER 4 HRS ·
\$10M+ ARR SUPPORTED

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Data governance leader with 15+ years in regulated financial services, enterprise data platforms, and technology control governance. Over 8 years at FICO, built and scaled a Detect → Resolve → Prevent → Govern → Scale operating model across 50+ financial-services clients — cutting control-related incidents 95% in three months, protecting 232M+ regulated records per cycle at 10,000 TPS, reducing worst-case resolution from 20-100 hours to under 4, and eliminating \$2M+ in annual failure costs. Known for translating governance standards into practical owner accountability, runbooks, evidence routines, and data quality controls across architecture, engineering, compliance, risk, and business teams.

"Metric driven and extraordinarily accountable" — Ken Bouley, Direct Manager, FICO Executive Leadership | 15 SPOT Awards | 11 LinkedIn Recommendations

CORE COMPETENCIES

Governance: Data Technology Control Governance · Data Governance Frameworks · DAMA-DMBOK · Technology Controls · Application / Information / Data Owner Models · Metadata Standards · Runbooks & Evidence Routines

Leadership: Cross-LOB Stakeholder Influence · Executive Forums · Issue Escalation & RCA · Audit-Ready Evidence · Team Leadership (11 direct reports, 25+ engineer org, 3 countries)

Platforms & Regulatory: Microsoft Purview · Collibra · ServiceNow · AWS · Python · SQL · CI/CD · Data Lineage · SOX · GDPR · DPDP · SOC 2 / ISO 27001

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant — Data & AI Governance

Self-employed · Bengaluru (Remote) | Apr 2025 – Present

Established after a planned, good-standing resignation from FICO — a deliberate move to balance a family caregiving responsibility with independent work (full 90-day notice served; caregiving now well-supported).

- Enterprise Data Steward engagement via Toptal — metadata standards, DQ rules, and stewardship workflows for a global client.
- Author, The Governed Data & AI Brief — 2,400+ subscriber newsletter on data & AI governance and regulatory readiness.
- DAMA CDMP Master — certified Sep 2026 (Credential #21979773); underlying exams Fundamentals 88% / Governance 83% / Data Quality 88%.
- Anthropic certified: Model Context Protocol — Advanced Topics; Claude Code in Action (2026).
- Designed, built and shipped three live governed systems — see Selected Innovations below.

Fair Isaac Corporation (FICO) — Enterprise Data Platform

Bengaluru, India (+ teams in the US & Canada) | Oct 2016 – Mar 2025 (8 yrs 6 mos)

Senior Engineer — Senior Individual Contributor (lateral, same grade, at my request) | Oct 2024 – Mar 2025

- Requested a lateral move (same grade, compensation unchanged) from people management to the senior IC track to support a family caregiving responsibility.
- Awarded FY24 merit increase and full bonus (Dec 2024); delivered six major DPL/ADE releases on schedule plus COGS-reduction capabilities.
- Resigned Dec 2024; served full 90-day notice through Mar 2025.

Senior Manager — Data Management, Enterprise Data Platform | Jun 2022 – Sep 2024

- Owned data technology control governance for 50+ financial-services clients; led an 11-member governance team within a 25+ member platform organisation across India, the US, and Canada, with hiring, performance, and tooling-roadmap ownership.
- Cut control-related incidents 95% in three months; reduced worst-case resolution from 20-100 hrs to under 4 hrs.
- Supported \$10M+ ARR; delivered \$2M+ annual savings; compressed client onboarding from 4 weeks to 2-3 days.
- Protected 232M+ regulated records per extraction at 10,000 TPS — SHA-256/512 masking, KMS-backed salts, and 100+ PII controls.

- Implemented AI/ML governance controls — explainability, drift monitoring, model-risk evidence, privacy controls, and audit-ready documentation.
- Defined Application / Information / Data Owner accountability models; represented governance in executive and cross-LOB forums.

Manager — Enterprise Data Platform, Data Operations & Governance | *Dec 2018 – Jun 2022*

- Governed enterprise metadata and validation platforms (AWS Athena, Python, Boto3), cutting pipeline incidents 50% in three months and enforcing quality checks at ingest.
- Scaled SLA-driven reconciliation, CI/CD quality gates, and change controls across 75GB+ batch workloads and 2.5M–3M API calls per cycle.
- Built row-level reconciliation reporting (records received, processed, failed, validation errors) for full audit traceability; reduced downstream escalations 45%.

Lead / Associate Manager — Data Management Platform | *Oct 2016 – Dec 2018*

- Built the enterprise ingestion, validation, transformation, and reconciliation pipelines that later scaled into FICO's data reliability platform.
- Delivered COBOL-to-JSON transformation for 3,500-column datasets, 25–35GB files, and 5M records within a 2-hour SLA.
- Established privacy-preserving masking across 100+ PII JSON paths — the foundation later scaled to protect 232M+ regulated records.
- Led technical reviews and RFP inputs contributing to 6+ new enterprise clients and \$5M in new ARR.

HCL Technologies — Technical Lead, Data Migration, Reconciliation & Guidewire Integration

Apr 2015 – Oct 2016

- Designed Guidewire Insurance Suite migration frameworks and pipeline optimisations for BFSI clients — reducing delivery time ~32%, improving ingestion 40%, and query performance 30%.

EY (Ernst & Young) • Cognizant • RR Donnelley — Associate Tech Lead / Programmer Analyst / Software Engineer

Jul 2009 – Mar 2015

- Delivered BFSI data migration, reconciliation, and technology control programs, progressing into cross-functional validation and delivery leadership.

SELECTED INNOVATIONS & LIVE SYSTEMS

- Metadata-Driven Data Quality Framework (FICO): reduced resolution from 20–100 hrs to under 4 hrs and compressed client onboarding from 4 weeks to 2–3 days.
- Secure PII Masking & Zero-Trust Ingestion (FICO): protected 232M+ records at 10,000 TPS with classification, masking, tokenization, and audit logs.
- Golden Record RAG Pipeline (self-built • live): resolves 89,198 source records into 20,502 trusted golden records; 35K RAG chunks; FastAPI + Postgres/pgvector.
- MediGovern RAG (self-built • live): governed clinical AI for prior authorization — six-rule data-quality gate, explicit abstention on conflicting evidence, immutable audit packet; CMS-0057-F aligned (synthetic data, no PHI).
- Pipeline Pulse / Platform Hub (self-built • live): DMBOK-aligned enterprise control plane — metadata-driven DQ, lineage, governance and AI-governance screens — plus runbooks, control templates, and 6 DAMA-aligned learning tracks.

CERTIFICATIONS

- DAMA CDMP Master — certified Sep 2026, Credential #21979773 (valid to 2029) • exams: Fundamentals 88% • Data Governance 83% • Data Quality 88%.
- Anthropic — Model Context Protocol: Advanced Topics (2026) • Claude Code in Action (2026).
- Scrum Master (2025) • SAFe • Guidewire Data Hub & InfoCenter • 15 SPOT Awards (FICO) • 11 LinkedIn Recommendations.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (M.C.A.) — KGISL Institute of Information Management • 2005–2008

B.Sc., Mathematics & Statistics — University of Calicut • 2002–2005